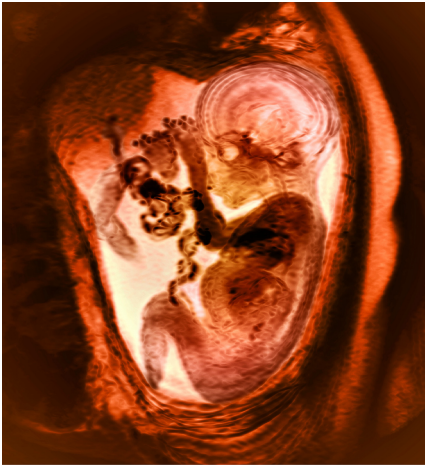




YOU ARE **37 WEEKS EXACTLY**
21 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This baby is lying in the breech position, with the umbilical cord seen as it travels toward the placenta in the top-left side of the image. Approximately 3 in every 100 babies will be in a breech position after 37 weeks.

“Your baby is now able to hear many sounds that will all be familiar to him once he’s born.”

In this late stage of pregnancy, sounds penetrate the uterus easily and there is no doubt that the baby can hear and respond to these before birth. Your baby will startle at loud sounds, but now also will turn toward familiar sounds, and practice looking for the source of the sound. Your baby is not only recognizing a wider range of sound frequencies but also discriminating between different sounds as well as learning and remembering familiar sounds, such as your voice and that of your partner.

Your baby breathes more quickly when they’re concentrating on sounds and their heart rate increases. Although the baby can hear at birth, the ear drum continues to thin out, at the same time becoming more mobile and responsive to sounds. Your voice will be the most familiar sound to your baby at birth.

ASK A DOCTOR

What if I can’t breastfeed? It’s normal to have doubts, but be reassured that most women have enough milk, and with some help with positioning, the baby can breastfeed without any problems. By this stage, you may even be leaking colostrum (see [Leaking breast milk](#)).

Try to keep an open mind and remember that the breast milk does not come in right after the birth (see [When your milk comes in](#)). Even if you have problems, try to persevere and don’t feel pressured to give up just because it’s convenient for the hospital staff or your partner, or because a friend or family member tells you it’s not necessary.

Even if you don’t end up breastfeeding, you can still get close to your baby by bottle-feeding.

FOCUS ON PARTNERS

You aren’t alone if you’re a partner who’s feeling a bit bewildered and shell-shocked by the imminent arrival of your baby. To begin with, you can expect a lot of changes at home. Once your